
Native Languages, Level 1, Open (NL1)**(LNAAO – LNOAO)**

This course is open to the entire student body and will allow students who have no prior Native language experience to develop an appreciation for a Native language and culture, to explore and experience a unique world view, and to learn to speak a Native language. Students will use the language being studied for greetings and daily routines, become familiar with its writing and sound system, and practise basic vocabulary and phrases. Students will also use information technology during course-related activities.

Oral Communication

Overall Expectations

By the end of NL1, students will:

- demonstrate basic listening skills;
- converse on familiar topics in structured situations;
- demonstrate an understanding of language structures and vocabulary in context;
- demonstrate an awareness of Native oral traditions (e.g., Native legends, stories, songs);
- use information technology to communicate in a Native language.

Specific Expectations

Reasoning and Critical Thinking

By the end of NL1, students will:

- demonstrate an understanding of information from illustrated stories or dialogues;
- arrange a set of illustrations in appropriate sequence after listening to a story read aloud;
- reconstruct dialogues, conversations, narrations, and presentations in sequence through artwork or oral expression;
- talk about basic oral texts, asking and responding to specific questions;
- distinguish contrasts (e.g., singular/plural, negative/affirmative, assertive/interrogative);
- demonstrate an understanding of Native legends and stories enacted or told with visual support.
- converse using simple and compound sentences;
- use basic greetings;
- respond to statements, questions, and directives given orally by the teacher;
- recite or sing simple rhymes and songs;
- participate in language games;
- represent and interpret a character in a skit set in a Native community;
- retell simple Native legends and stories.

Media Communication Skills

By the end of NL1, students will:

- use information technology to:
- record a short dialogue to share with other students;
- listen to tapes of Native elders telling stories;
- produce media works for listening or viewing;
- communicate in a Native language with other students.

Use of Words and Language Structures

By the end of NL1, students will:

- recite vowel and consonant sounds;
- use the sounds of the language to build words to do with familiar topics;
- express ideas, feelings, and opinions using known language structures;

Reading

Overall Expectations

By the end of NL1, students will:

- read simple material on familiar topics in structured situations;
- recognize language patterns and vocabulary that have been learned through oral work;
- read for comprehension of ideas;
- demonstrate an understanding of language conventions and vocabulary in simple texts;
- use information technology to communicate in a Native language.

Specific Expectations

Reasoning and Critical Thinking

By the end of NL1, students will:

- demonstrate an understanding of simple texts;
- extract information from a written passage;
- identify the theme and supporting details of a story or poem;
- translate simple texts with the assistance of a dictionary or word list.

Use of Words and Language Structures

By the end of NL1, students will:

- read aloud, enunciating words clearly and using proper intonation;
- demonstrate an understanding of basic vocabulary in simple sentences;
- select, list, and define new vocabulary in texts;
- use all available cues (e.g., context, language patterns, form, graphic symbols) to determine the meaning of new vocabulary;
- determine appropriate titles for passages or stories;
- follow simple written instructions;
- read a variety of simple texts;
- respond appropriately to written questions.

Media Communication Skills

By the end of NL1, students will:

- use information technology to:
 - locate reading material in the Native language;
 - build a knowledge base on a Native topic;
 - communicate in a Native language with other students.

Writing

Overall Expectations

By the end of NL1, students will:

- use a variety of simple and compound sentences;
- write on familiar topics, expressing ideas clearly;
- demonstrate accuracy in writing and a knowledge of linguistic conventions;
- use information technology to communicate in a Native language.

Specific Expectations

Reasoning and Critical Thinking

By the end of NL1, students will:

- distinguish between grammatical forms (e.g., number, gender, tense);
- identify word classifications (e.g., nouns, pronouns, verbs) in text;
- demonstrate an understanding of word order in simple sentences.

Media Communication Skills

By the end of NL1, students will:

- use information technology to:
 - write and record a short dialogue;
 - edit with peers;
- communicate in a Native language with other students.

Use of Words and Language Structures

By the end of NL1, students will:

- write short sentences using correct punctuation;
- use a variety of familiar expressions and vocabulary correctly in written works;
- use new words accurately in sentences;
- communicate ideas (e.g., thoughts, feelings, experiences) clearly for specific purposes;
- use correct spelling of basic and new vocabulary;
- organize information into short paragraphs that contain a main idea and related details;
- write short pieces using a variety of forms;
- revise written work with the assistance of classmates and the teacher;
- use grammar, language conventions, and vocabulary appropriate to this course.

Grammar, Language Conventions, and Vocabulary

Structure of Native Languages

A knowledge of the structure of a language allows students to analyse and reflect on its use, thereby stimulating their interest in language itself, deepening their understanding of the language being learned, and helping them to develop their writing skills.

Investigation and discussion of the rules of syntax and grammar that underlie the language patterns of the Native language under study will complement language learning. Language patterns for the two Native language families in Ontario are different and thus listed separately.

Sentence Structure

In Native languages, sentences are expressed in a variety of ways that may include one or more of the following parts of speech: verbs, nouns, pronouns, particles, and conjunctions. A whole sentence can be expressed by a verb and its inflections, attained by adding one or more affixes. Sometimes a particle can express a complete thought. Sentences may also consist of one or more clauses that in English would be parallel to simple, compound, complex, or compound-complex constructions.

Spelling Strategies

Use of:

- cluster and syllable recognition
- capitalization
- punctuation
- diacritical marks
- resources to confirm spelling (e.g., classroom-displayed lists, texts, dictionaries, information technology)

Vocabulary

Use of:

- basic vocabulary (*sample list*: numbers from 1 to 50; time; calendar; seasons; colours; domestic animals; buildings; objects in the classroom; family members; clothing; food; games)
- new words from units of study and personal and class word lists
- a Native–English dictionary to build vocabulary

Algonquian Language Family

Verbs

- *Type*
 - animate intransitive
 - inanimate intransitive
 - inanimate transitive
 - animate transitive
- *Tense*
 - present
 - simple past
 - intentional future
- *Person*
 - first, second, third
 - regular, irregular
- *Number*
 - singular
 - plural

- *Order*
 - imperative
 - simple direct commands
 - independent
 - simple statements
 - conjunct
 - interrogative sentences
 - content questions
 - complex sentences
- *Negation*
 - yes/no questions
 - simple negation
- *Voice*
 - active

Nouns

- *Type*
 - locative
 - diminutive
 - possessive
 - dependent
 - pejorative
- *Gender*
 - animate
 - inanimate
- *Case*
 - subject
 - object

- *Number*
 - singular
 - plural
- *Person*
 - third
 - proximate
 - obviative

Pronouns

- *Type*
 - personal
 - independent
 - interrogative
 - demonstrative
- *Number*
 - singular
 - plural
- *Person*
 - first, second, third
 - proximate
 - obviative

Particles

- *Type*
 - question particle
 - conjunctions
 - quantifiers
 - adverbs indicating time, place, manner, degree

Iroquoian Language Family

Verbs

- *Classification*
 - subjective
 - one or two stems
 - objective
 - one or two stems
- *Conjugations*
 - pronouns
 - first, second, third person
 - personal
 - singular (*I, you, he, she, it*)
 - plural (*they* [males], *they* [females], *all of you*)
 - tenses
 - imperatives
 - interactive

- *Incorporation*
 - use of prefixes, infixes, suffixes
- *Irregular verbs*

Nouns

- *Classification*
 - formal
 - functional
 - animate
 - inanimate
- *Independent possessives*
 - singular, plural
 - use with locatives
 - use to indicate kinship
- *Independent pronouns*
- *Independent numeration*

- *Independent locatives*
- *Independent adjectives*
- *Incorporation*
 - numeration
 - use with a verb
 - adjectival construction
 - pluralizers
 - locatives

Sentences

- *Types*
 - simple
 - compound
 - complex
- *Gender agreement*
- *Creation of negatives*
- *Creation of questions*

Particles

- *Type*
 - question particle
 - conjunctions
 - quantifiers
 - adverbs indicating time, place, manner, degree